

MONDAY

FOCUS ON: Timothy

READ TOGETHER: 1 Timothy 4:12-16

ANCHORED BY MODELING

Let no one despise your youth, but be an example
to the believers in word, in conduct, in love, in
spirit, in faith, in purity. (1 Timothy 4:12)

FOR FAMILY WORSHIP: Pages 18-20

FURTHER STUDY FOR PARENTS: Pages 21-23

A LIFE THAT SPEAKS BY ACTIONS

The room grows quiet as Timothy steps forward. Sandals scrape the floor. Someone coughs. Older faces look up. Some eyes are kind. Some are not sure. Timothy is young, and everyone knows it.

His heart beats fast, like a little drum. He may wonder, "Will they listen?" The room feels big. His voice feels small. Then he remembers Paul's words, like a hand on his shoulder: "Let no one despise your youth, but be an example to the believers in word, in conduct, in love, in spirit, in faith, in purity" (1 Timothy 4:12).

Paul does not tell Timothy to pretend he is older. He does not say, "Talk louder." He does not say, "Make people respect you." Paul gives him something better. Be an example.

That means Timothy can lead with his life. His words can be gentle. His actions can be brave. His love can help people feel Jesus near. Before

Timothy teaches, he can teach with his choices.

We live in a **VUCA WORLD**. Life can feel shaky, confusing, busy, and hard to understand. Plans change. Screens blink, buzz, and call our names. Games, videos, messages, and likes can pull our eyes and hearts away.

But a good example is like a small light in a dark room. It does not shout. It shines so others can find their way.

Today, let's ask God to help our home shine. We do not have to be perfect. We can say sorry and try again. With God's help, our words can heal. Our phones can wait. Our choices can say, "God is first, and you matter to me."

Timothy was young, but he could lead. You can lead too. Your kindness can lead. Your honesty can lead. Your brave choice can lead.

Before we make more rules, let's become the message. With God's help, our lives can shine.

READ

ASK

FAMILY PRAYER

Place a small light in the center and pray: **"Jesus, help our words, choices, love, faith, and purity shine brighter than our screens today. In Your name, amen."**

Timothy's new responsibilities felt like this:

And this is how God leads us to be an example to others:

VOLATILE: New churches faced danger.

VENTURE: God gives courage to model.

UNCERTAIN: Young leader, big responsibility.

UNVEIL: Our example teaches quietly.

COMPLEX: Many pressures around him.

COMPASS: God invites you to live what you ask.

AMBIGUOUS: How to lead elders as a young person?

ASSURANCE: Families grow stronger together.

In a **VUCA WORLD**, Timothy shows us that true courage grows when our life becomes a steady example for others.

1 Read
1 Timothy 4:12

2 Underline
the word
"example"

3 Ask yourself:

- Do I act online the same way I talk?
- What are children learning by watching me?

Timothy teaches us something important: eyes are always learning. When I put my phone away, listen with love, say sorry, and choose God, I am showing you the way. **You learn wise choices not only from my words, but from my example.**

FAMILY ACTIVITY: Our Promise Chain

Cut paper into strips. On each strip, draw or write one way your family will use screens wisely: grown-ups put phones down first, meals stay screen-free, everyone asks for help when pressure feels big, and we plan fun screen-free time together. Tape the strips into one chain and hang it where everyone can see. **Ask: What are we showing each other?**



**FURTHER STUDY
FOR PARENTS:**

ANCHORED BY MODELING

Today's Principle:
Modeling Builds Authority

Today's promise for your home is quiet and powerful:
Your daily example can teach your children what wise screen use looks like.

Timothy reminds parents that children learn courage by watching consistent love. In a noisy, screen-filled world, our example can build moral authority, shape your family culture, and help children see Jesus in daily choices.

V VENTURE BEYOND FEAR IN A VOLATILE WORLD

Timothy's life teaches parents a simple but powerful truth: in a confusing world, authority is not built by force. It is built by example.

As a parent, you do not need to lead your home by being louder, stricter, or perfect. You lead best when your children can see consistency in you. They learn from your words, but also from your habits, tone, attention, and the way you respond when life feels stressful.

This is especially true with screens. Before children fully understand every rule, they are already watching how the adults in the home use their devices. They notice if the phone comes to the table. They notice if messages interrupt conversations. They notice if social media changes the mood of the home.

Today, choose one visible act that sets an example. Put the phone away during a family moment. Apologize if you have been distracted. Let your words online and at home reflect love, faith, and purity.

YOUR LIFE SPEAKS BEFORE YOUR RULES, AND YOUR EXAMPLE HELPS SHAPE THE COURAGE YOUR CHILDREN WILL CARRY.

U

UNVEIL DEEPER TRUTH IN UNCERTAIN TIMES

Read 1 Timothy 4:12 slowly. Underline the word example. Then look at the five places Paul names: words, behavior, love, faith, and purity. Ask God to help you see what your children may already be learning from you.

If you use a device, pause and ask: What do my digital words say? Does my online behavior match what I teach at home? Am I the same when no one tags me, watches me, or praises me?

MORAL AUTHORITY IS NOT DEMANDED. IT IS BUILT, LITTLE BY LITTLE, WHEN YOUR CHILDREN SEE YOU LIVING WHAT YOU ASK THEM TO PRACTICE.

C

COMPASS THAT REMAINS STEADY THROUGH COMPLEXITY

Modeling means living, as much as possible, what you are asking your children to learn. This is one of the beautiful educational principles from the writings of Ellen White: the home teaches before any lesson is spoken. She wrote, ***"In the formation of character, no other influences count so much as the influence of the home"*** (Education, p. 283).

For a busy parent, this is not meant to feel heavy. It is not another reason to feel guilty. It is an invitation to see how powerful your everyday choices can be. Your child is learning when you pray, when you pause, when you listen, when you put the phone away, and even when you say, "I was wrong. I'm sorry. Let's try again."

Modeling is not perfection. It is consistency. Perfection says, "I must never fail." Consistency says, "When I fail, I return to what matters." A consistent parent does not demand a screen habit that they are unwilling to practice. A consistent parent keeps learning with the child, not standing above the child. This kind of leadership feels safe because it grows from relationship, not pressure.

Paul did not tell Timothy, "Make them respect you." He said, "Be an example" (1 Timothy 4:12, NKJV). That same principle works at home. When your child sees the phones leave the dinner table because

Mom or Dad put it away first, a lesson is being taught. When conversation matters more than notifications, family culture is being built. When rest time is protected, the home becomes calmer. When social media is not allowed to rule everyone's mood, children begin to see freedom.

So the question is not only, "What screen rules should I set?" The deeper question is, "What am I showing my children so they can learn?"

YOUR STEADY EXAMPLE CAN BECOME THE QUIET COMPASS THAT GUIDES YOUR FAMILY TOWARD JESUS.

A ASSURANCE THAT STANDS FIRM AMID AMBIGUITY

This week, practice **THE PARENT SCREEN HUDDLE**. Before making new rules for your children, sit down as parents and honestly assess your own screen habits. Modeling needs support, and it begins with the adults in the home.

Choose a quiet moment this week. Ask each other: How are we using our phones in front of our children? Where are we inconsistent? At what age do we believe it's wise to get a first smartphone? How can we support each other when outside pressure feels strong?

Then write a short family agreement: "We will improve our adult screen habits first, delay the use of smartphones wisely, speak up when pressure comes, and create offline ways for our children to connect."

REMEMBER: WHAT ARE WE MODELING BEFORE WE ARE ASKING?



ANCHORED BY MODELING

Do not aim to control children. Show them another way. Timothy was young, but steady. In a **VUCA WORLD**, example becomes authority. Children are watching. What do they see today?